EOS-33 · FRONT OFFICE · CAPITAL MARKETS THEMATICS

Five verticals. One published view per quarter. Research as origination.

The thematic desk is where the firm develops, codifies and publishes its capital-markets view across the five verticals we cover. Research is not academic exercise — it is positioning, origination hook, and LP-credibility asset. Each thematic lands with a deal-lead's view of capital flows, a regulatory map, a proprietary origination angle, and a publishing cadence calibrated to LP discoverability.

THEMATIC PILLARS	PUBLISHED YTD	DISTRIBUTION LIST	AVG OPEN RATE	LEADS ATTRIBUTED	NEXT PUBLISH
5	8	384	42%	11	15 May
All active · quarterly cadence	vs 4 target · +100%	112 LPs · 172 GPs · 100 other	vs 22% industry bench	Research-sourced YTD	Data Centre Capital Cycle

PARTNER READ

"Research is a patient channel. It doesn't ring a doorbell — it builds a reputation. When a credit fund's IC is short two pages on data-centre capital formation and one of those pages is our name, origination is already downstream."

Research serves three distinct audiences. **LPs** read it to decide whether we're institutional enough to be trusted with capital. **Sponsors and GPs** read it to decide whether we understand their problem. **Brokers and counsel** read it to decide whether to refer to us. Every published piece is written with a view to all three — but any individual piece can be weighted. The Digital Infra pieces read toward sponsors. The Private Credit pieces read toward LPs. The Upstream O&G pieces read toward brokers and operators.

Eight pieces published year-to-date against a target of four has surprised on the upside — driven by the agentic engine removing the 80% of authoring time that used to be formatting, brand compliance and distribution management. Attributable pipeline from research is 11 leads YTD (of 47 live) and 2 signed mandates. That makes research the fifth-ranked origination channel — but the first-ranked *brand-equity* channel. We publish to get discovered, not to ring the doorbell.

The Five Thematic Pillars

INSTITUTIONAL VIEWS · QUARTERLY REFRESH · PARTNER-AUTHORED

THEMATIC 01 · ENERGY TRANSITION

A$2.8T GLOBAL CAPEX

Capital is abundant — bankability is scarce.

Our view: the transition thesis is no longer about capital availability. It is about structuring capital so it lands in bankable form on risk-appropriate assets.

Market Thesis

The market has moved past capital-availability as the binding constraint on transition capex. A$2.8T of announced global capex is chasing too few bankable structures — we see discrepancies of 2-3x between sponsor demand and senior-debt willingness across wind/solar/hydrogen. The structural opportunity is not *raising capital*; it is *arranging capital* such that the risk-return re-segments correctly across the stack (senior, mezz, prefs, equity co-invest) and PPAs / offtakes are matched to the tenor of each tranche.

Capital Flows

APAC transition capex has flipped from government-anchored to institutional-anchored in 24 months. Three pools are now active: (i) dedicated transition credit funds at A$15-50M/deal; (ii) super pension mandates at A$75-150M via infra allocators; (iii) sovereign/strategic capital at A$200M+ for scaled assets. Our job is to bridge sponsors to the right pool, at the right tranche, at a bankable cost.

PIPELINE SHARE	LIVE MANDATES	AVG DEAL SIZE
28%	3	A$165M

PROPRIETARY DATA POINT

We track 38 transition capex announcements in APAC >A$50M; of those, 22 are funded-in-principle but structurally stuck on PPA tenor vs senior-debt tenor. That gap is where arrangement fee lives.

ORIGINATION HOOK

"We run a live monitor of 38 APAC transition projects where capital is committed-in-principle but structure is unresolved. If you're inside that list, we should talk."

AU	US	EU	APAC
Safeguard Mechanism · CEFC · AEMO alignment	IRA ITC/PTC transferability · §45Q · §48D	CBAM · RED III · EU Taxonomy	JP GX · KR-ETS · SG national hydrogen

THEMATIC 02 · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

Power is the new land — and the land is not sold out yet.

A$1.4T DC CAPEX · 5YR

Our view: the data-centre capex thesis is compute-bounded, then power-bounded, then capital-bounded. The arbitrage for Ascension is at the power-to-capital handoff.

Market Thesis

Data-centre demand is no longer the constraint. The constraint is power — and the capital-formation machine around long-duration, grid-interactive, hyperscaler-anchored power contracts. Hyperscaler leases of 15-20yrs with annual escalators are structurally financeable at investment-grade-adjacent terms; what moves is where the development risk and stranding risk get priced, and how equity / mezz / senior stack splits between sponsor, developer and financier.

Capital Flows

DC capex has bifurcated. Hyperscaler-anchored build-to-suit is 80% institutional-financeable on senior terms. Speculative wholesale DC is 20% institutional — the rest is GP equity, credit-fund mezz and sponsor balance-sheet. The highest-fee corridor for Ascension is structuring the capital stack for sponsor-developer JVs where hyperscaler leases are signed but senior debt is not yet syndicated.

PIPELINE SHARE	LIVE MANDATES	AVG DEAL SIZE
22%	2	A$210M

PROPRIETARY DATA POINT

APAC wholesale DC capacity signed-but-unfinanced stands at 1.8GW across 14 projects. Senior debt attach is the principal blocker; mezz or prefs unlock the senior — and that's exactly the arrangement we do.

ORIGINATION HOOK

"We structure capital stacks for hyperscaler-anchored DC JVs where equity is in, leases are signed, and senior debt is blocked. If you're in this gap, we've done it."

AU	US	EU	APAC
ASIC AFSL for DC funds · AER grid approvals	Tax-advantaged REIT DC structures · CFIUS	GDPR data-locality · Energy Efficiency Dir	Sing PDPA · JP APPI · KR PIPA

THEMATIC 03 · UPSTREAM O&G

Capital discipline has made upstream the cleanest yield in energy.

A$450B UPSTREAM CAPEX · 5YR

Our view: capital-starved, cash-generative, short-cycle upstream is mispriced by ESG-driven capital withdrawal. The structured-credit opportunity is priced asymmetrically to the credit risk.

Market Thesis

Upstream has been capital-rationed for five years. Result: survivors are low-cost, low-leverage, cash-generative operators who cannot access mainstream senior debt at reasonable cost because ESG-mandated capital has walked. This creates a structural opportunity for non-bank private credit at 300-500bps of premium to comparable credit quality in other sectors. The trade is not commodity exposure — it's credit-risk mispricing driven by capital-flow, not fundamentals.

Capital Flows

The active pools in upstream credit: (i) specialist private credit funds (Northcrest, Stellar Debt, Riverstone), A$50-120M/deal; (ii) RBL (reserve-based lending) syndicates — contracting but not gone; (iii) offtake-indexed structures (trader-financing) — growing fast; (iv) strategic capital (NOC / IOC balance-sheet into producer equity). Senior-unsecured bond markets are functionally closed to sub-IG operators — our arrangement-fee corridor.

PIPELINE SHARE	LIVE MANDATES	AVG DEAL SIZE
18%	1	A$95M

PROPRIETARY DATA POINT

11 independent APAC producers are refinancing RBL facilities in 2026-27 at a 1.4x senior-debt attach gap. Offtake-indexed and hedge-supported structures close that gap at 11-14% yield to non-bank credit.

ORIGINATION HOOK

"We arrange offtake-indexed credit for upstream producers stranded between RBL senior and prefs. The mispricing is real — the structure is the alpha."

AU	US	EU	APAC
Scope 1/2/3 disclosure · Safeguard	SEC climate rules · state-level moratoria	CSRD · EU Taxonomy exclusion	JP GX transition finance allowance

THEMATIC 04 · CRITICAL MINERALS

Policy is pulling capital — capital is not pulling minerals.

A$350B CRITICAL MINERALS CAPEX

Our view: the supply-chain sovereignty narrative has unlocked government capital but not yet private institutional capital. That asymmetry is the opportunity — and the risk.

Market Thesis

Critical-minerals capex has one of the strongest political pulls in modern capital markets (US IRA §30D, AU Critical Minerals Strategy, EU CRMA, JP METI funds) — but private institutional capital is underweight. That leaves two gaps: (i) junior developer financing at the construction stage; (ii) processing / midstream financing where EV / battery / defence offtake is contracted but capital

Capital Flows

Three pools: (i) strategic Asian capital (Japanese trading houses, Korean battery-cell makers) taking minority equity for offtake; (ii) sovereign grants / concessional loans (US DOE, EXIM, AU EFA, JBIC) up to 25-35% of project cost; (iii) specialist private credit, mezzanine, royalty and streaming funds. The Ascension hook is assembling the three into a bankable stack for a junior-developer sponsor.

is bank-rationed. Government grants close 15-35% of the stack — private credit closes the rest at double-digit unlevered yield.

PIPELINE SHARE	LIVE MANDATES	AVG DEAL SIZE
16%	1	A$125M

PROPRIETARY DATA POINT

Of 42 announced APAC critical-minerals projects targeting FID by 2027, 28 have offtake contracted, 19 have grant-funding committed, but only 6 have senior-debt arranged. Eighteen structurally match our mandate profile.

ORIGINATION HOOK

"We assemble bankable stacks for critical-minerals projects where offtake is contracted and concessional capital is committed, but senior credit is unresolved."

AU	US	EU	APAC
Critical Minerals Strategy · EFA facility	IRA §30D · DOE LPO · DoD DPA-III	CRMA · EIB strategic projects	JP JOGMEC · KR KOMIR · MMG stream

THEMATIC 05 · STRUCTURED PRIVATE CREDIT & SPECIAL SITUATIONS

The middle market is too big for banks and too small for syndication.

A$180B APAC PRIV CREDIT AUM

Our view: sub-IG non-sponsor credit in APAC is a structurally underserved segment with premium pricing, covenant-heavy deals, and low correlation to syndicated-market flows.

Market Thesis

APAC private credit has scaled to A$180B AUM but is 70% sponsor-backed. The other 30% — non-sponsor, corporate, event-driven, real-asset-backed — is where Ascension arranges. These deals are structurally higher-yield (800-1,200bps premium to senior loans), covenant-dense, and require bespoke structuring rather than syndication muscle. The segment is too small for syndicated markets, too complex for house lending, and too bespoke for commoditised private-credit platforms — which is precisely the corridor we occupy.

Capital Flows

Active pools: (i) local APAC private credit funds (11 tier-1); (ii) global platforms with APAC teams (Ares, HPS, Apollo, Blackstone Credit); (iii) super-pension direct credit mandates (A$500M+ ceiling); (iv) family office / UHNW direct allocations. The bankable ticket is A$50-150M senior, A$20-60M mezz, A$10-30M prefs. Ascension's edge: bespoke structuring and counterparty-introduction machinery no sub-A$500M AUM fund has.

PIPELINE SHARE	LIVE MANDATES	AVG DEAL SIZE
16%	2	A$85M

PROPRIETARY DATA POINT

Non-sponsor APAC private credit yield premium to sponsor-backed has widened from 180bps to 320bps over 24 months. Conversion rate on our non-sponsor mandates: 46% — highest of any vertical.

ORIGINATION HOOK

"We arrange bespoke private credit for non-sponsor APAC borrowers where premium pricing compensates for complexity. Too small for syndication, too complex for platforms — which is exactly the corridor we own."

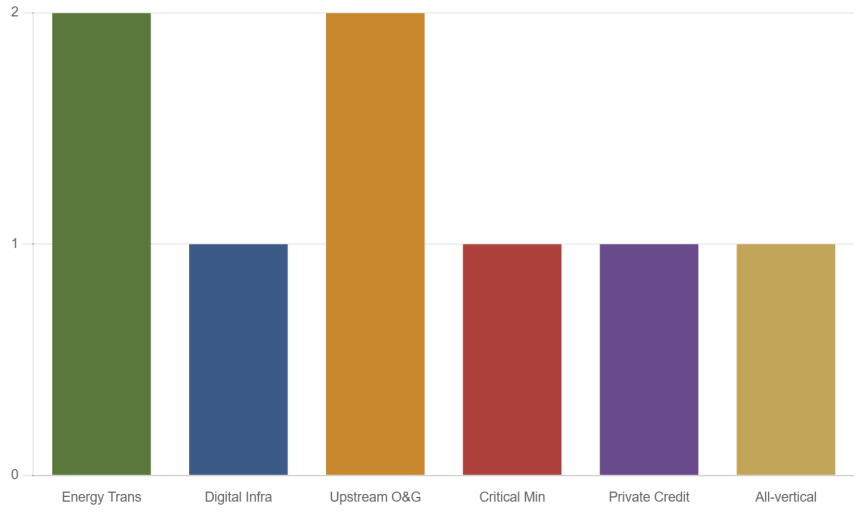
AU	US	EU	APAC
AFSL private-credit fund licence · AUSTRAC	BDC regime · Reg D placement	AIFMD marketing · ELTIF 2.0	SG VCC · HK OFC · JP financial code

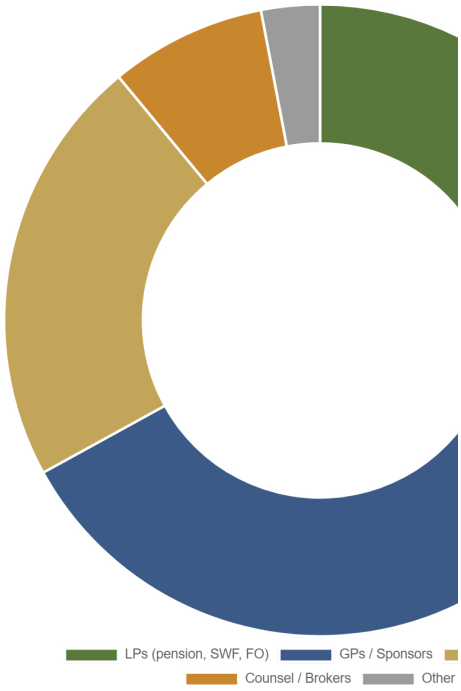
Publishing Performance

YTD PUBLICATION METRICS · READERSHIP ENGAGEMENT

Published Pieces by Vertical · YTD

Readership Breakdown





YTD Publications & Attribution

8 PIECES · 11 LEADS ATTRIBUTED · 2 SIGNED MANDATES

PIECE	VERTICAL	PUBLISHED	FORMAT	OPENS	DOWNLOADS	LEADS	MANDATES	HOOK GRADE
APAC Transition Capex · Bankability Gap	Energy Transition	15 Jan 2026	10-pager	162	48	3	1 (Zenith)	A
Hyperscaler-Anchored DC: Capital Stack	Digital Infra	05 Feb 2026	12-pager	184	62	2	1 (Delta)	A+
Offtake-Indexed Credit for Upstream	Upstream O&G	22 Feb 2026	8-pager	98	24	1	0	B
Critical Minerals · Concessional Capital Map	Critical Minerals	10 Mar 2026	14-pager	142	51	2	0	A
Non-Sponsor Private Credit · The Premium	Private Credit	28 Mar 2026	10-pager	128	39	2	0	A
Thematic Quarterly Q1 · Capital Flow Map	All five	05 Apr 2026	Full report	218	104	1	0	A
Transition PPA Tenor Mismatch	Energy Transition	12 Apr 2026	6-pager	102	28	0	0	B+
Upstream Refi Wall · 2026-27	Upstream O&G	18 Apr 2026	6-pager	88	22	0	0	B

Publishing Cadence · Next Cycle

SCHEDULED THROUGH Q3 2026

Rhythm · Vertical × Format × Distribution

One major quarterly per vertical (10-14pp deep report). One short monthly (4-6pp data update). One live thematic quarterly across all verticals. Research platform feeds origination, LP brand, and distribution.

15 MAY 2026

Data Centre Capital Cycle · Part II

Digital Infra · 12-pp deep · hyperscaler demand x grid constraints. Target distribution: 172 GPs + sponsor CFOs. Hook: DC stack arrangement.

30 MAY 2026

Critical Minerals Concessional Map · v2

Critical Minerals · 14-pp refreshed. DOE LPO / EFA / JOGMEC / CRMA grant stack. Target: 48 junior developer sponsors.

10 JUN 2026

Transition Credit Quarterly · Q2

Energy Transition · 8-pp data update. Capex-to-senior-debt gap, PPA tenor, offtake heatmap. Target: 67 credit funds + pension mandates.

25 JUN 2026

Private Credit Vertical Primer · H2

Private Credit · 10-pp new thematic. Non-sponsor premium, covenant landscape, platform rankings. Target LPs: 112.

10 JUL 2026

Q2 Thematic Quarterly · Capital Flow Map

All five verticals · full 30-pp institutional report. Flagship publication of the cycle. Target: full 384-distribution list.

25 JUL 2026

Upstream Refi Wall · Update

Upstream O&G · 6-pp tracker refresh. RBL maturity schedule · offtake coverage. Target: 24 independent producers.

15 AUG 2026

DC Grid Constraints · Power as Binding Constraint

Digital Infra · 10-pp deep. AU / JP / SG grid maps. AEMO / METI / EMA interface. Target: hyperscaler + sponsor cohort.

30 AUG 2026

Critical Minerals Processing Midstream

Critical Minerals · 12-pp thematic. Battery cathode / precursor / lithium processing gap. Target: strategic Asian capital.